

JAMES PATTERSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 2 years of hands-on experience building REST APIs and microservices using Python and Node.js. I've worked on scaling database queries that reduced response times by 40% and contributed to production systems serving thousands of daily users. I'm keen on writing clean, maintainable code and learning from more experienced engineers. Based in Birmingham, actively looking to deepen my knowledge of system design and cloud infrastructure.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

June 2023 - Present

Developed and maintained 15+ REST API endpoints using Python Flask, handling authentication, data validation, and business logic for a SaaS platform serving 500+ active users.

Optimised PostgreSQL queries that reduced average API response time from 850ms to 520ms, improving user experience across the platform.

Implemented automated unit and integration tests using pytest, achieving 78% code coverage and reducing production bugs by 35%.

Collaborated with frontend team to design and document API specifications, resolving integration issues and supporting mobile app deployment.

Junior Backend Developer

DataStream Analytics

datastream.co

Solihull, United Kingdom

February 2023 - May 2023

Built microservices using Node.js and Express to process real-time data streams, handling approximately 2 million records daily.

Designed and created PostgreSQL database schemas with proper indexing and relationships, supporting three new product features.

Debugged and fixed critical production issues within 2-4 hours, maintaining 99.2% system uptime for payment processing module.

Participated in code reviews and contributed improvements to internal API documentation, helping onboard two new junior developers.

Junior Software Developer

BrightWeb Development

brightweb.net

Birmingham, United Kingdom

August 2022 - January 2023

Developed backend features for a content management system using Python Django, completing 12 user stories per two-week sprint.

Fixed 25+ bugs identified in testing and production environments, with emphasis on database-related issues and API edge cases.

Set up Docker containers and docker-compose configurations for local development, standardising the development environment across the team.

Assisted senior developers with basic DevOps tasks including log analysis, server monitoring, and deployment to staging environments.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science (Upper Second Class Honours)

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, SQL, Bash

Frameworks and Libraries: Flask, Django, Express.js, SQLAlchemy

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB

Tools and Platforms: Git, Docker, Linux, AWS (EC2, S3), Postman, Nginx

Testing: pytest, Jest, unittest

Other: REST API design, Microservices architecture, Git workflow

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/jpatterson92/flask-user-api - User management REST API built with Flask and PostgreSQL

github.com/jpatterson92/task-scheduler - Task scheduling microservice using Node.js and MongoDB

github.com/jpatterson92/expense-tracker-backend - Personal finance API with JWT authentication

github.com/jpatterson92/data-pipeline - Python ETL pipeline for processing CSV files